

Critical Thinking – Journaling Assignment

1. **Identify the biases that you are now able to relate to in your past experience. List the top three biases.**

Based on my past experiences, the three biases I relate to most are: Confirmation Bias, Availability Heuristic, and Anchoring Bias.

- a. Confirmation Bias: I've often sought metrics that validated decisions I'd already made, rather than genuinely testing them.
- b. Availability Heuristic: I've tended to overweight recent experiences when forming judgements; one bad interaction would lead me to generalize that the entire approach was flawed.
- c. Anchoring Bias: When I receive a first impression, estimate, or deadline, my further reasoning stays disproportionately tied to that initial anchor, even when new information clearly indicates a significant revision.

2. **Did you catch yourself when you went through Fast (Non-Conscious) Thinking and Slow (Deliberate) Thinking? Share your experience.**

I've caught myself switching between both modes clearly. Fast Thinking was the most visible when making instant judgements based on a single data point, a pattern-based response driven by my prior associations. Slow Thinking kicked in when I consciously paused, cross-referenced information, and deliberated before acting on it. I've also noticed Fast Thinking during time critical situations. When asked a quick question in my group, my verbal response often escaped before I've truly reasoned through it under the pretense of 'Thinking out loud'. This awareness has made me recognize that both modes are always in motion. The critical skill is noticing which one is driving me and deciding consciously whether to let it.

3. **Do you think eliminating emotions completely would be the right way to think critically? Share your experiences.**

I think the simple answer is No. Eliminating emotions entirely is neither possible nor desirable. Emotions carry real information. They tend to signal value where something may feel incoherent, and where intuition is flagging a risk worth examining. The goal I believe should be emotional awareness, not suppression. I've found that the best outcomes emerge when I acknowledge the emotion, consciously set it aside to reason

clearly, and then revisit it before acting. For instance, responding to a dismissive message purely logically might produce a technically correct reply but one that misses the emotional context entirely. Emotional intelligence and critical thinking work best as complementary tools. Emotions provide context and motivation, while deliberate reasoning ensures the response is proportionate and sound.

4. Pick a problem or bug that you worked on few months back. Now with this new awareness, how would you define the problem statement better if the problem was given to you today? Which method helped you to define the problem statement better?

A couple of months ago, I was working on a recurring failure in a scheduled job. At that moment, I defined the problem vaguely as “The job is failing intermittently”. With my current understanding, I would redefine it a lot more precisely, “The scheduled job fails under specific downstream dependency conditions, particularly during peak load times, leading to inconsistent execution outcomes”. This clearer statement separates symptoms from the root causes and introduces measurable conditions. The method that helped me here is problem decomposition and root cause analysis, along with asking more structured “why” questions. This ensures I don’t jump to conclusions and instead build a more accurate and actionable understanding of the issue.